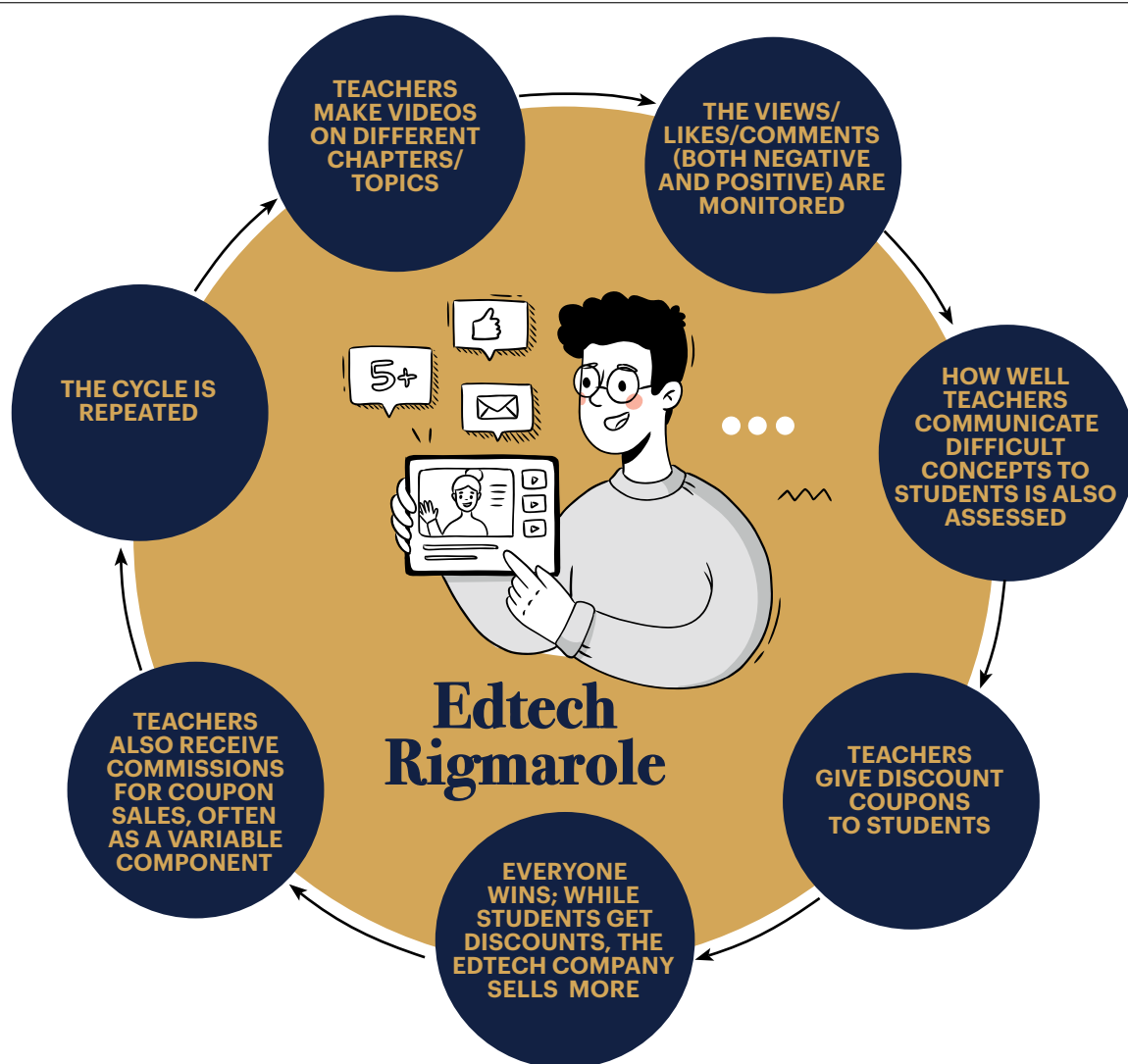




in the past two years who were willing to give me a 500 per cent raise,” says a star teacher to *BT*. A 500 per cent hike is “truly unheard of” in the sector, says Gupta.

However, with a higher pay package comes more responsibility. Working in an edtech company has become extremely “hectic and tiring”. “Earlier our focus was only on making content for the students. Now we are involved in making content for online and also handling operations of offline centres,” says the teacher mentioned above. And engaged as they are in their employers’ rat race, many feel that they are drifting away from the simple pleasure and spirit of teaching.

Not just that, the funding winter has resulted in layoffs at companies like BYJU’S, Unacademy, Vedantu, among others. Unacademy has even slashed salaries. “Unacademy’s leadership, including the founders will take a permanent salary cut. The reduction will depend on the current salary of the leaders, their scope and their performance. The salary cuts can go up to 25 per cent,”

Co-founder Gaurav Munjal said on the company’s internal messaging platform on March 31 this year.

A fair amount of scaling down is happening within the edtech sector. The salaries have come down from ₹3-4 crore to ₹1.5-2 crore—almost half, says the founder of the edtech unicorn company mentioned earlier. “People who were overpaid lost their jobs first. There has been a lot of restructuring,” the founder says.

The way the edtech ecosystem has played out in recent times makes one wonder if traditional institutions and the talent pool is interested in joining edtechs. Job stability and number of paid leaves are the reasons why traditional setups continue to beat edtechs, according to experts. With edtechs now encouraged to integrate new-age tech tools like AI and ChatGPT for teaching and materials, will the millionaire teachers be able to keep their mojo? Only time will tell. **BT**

@bhavyakaushal2